Media and AI



Literacy Tool

Summmary

With the rise of AI, there are concerns in education around students use of it for ‘cheating’, with NCEA reports of cheating in exams spiking since NZQA started investigating (The Spinoff, 2026). With the advancement of AI, teaching AI ethics and media literacy in education is becoming more and more important, as younger people use generative AI over their own voices. In a future of generative AI enhancements across almost every industry, personal creativity, flexible thinking, and AI literacy will be important for the next generation of workers to stand out and show their worth.

Through a literacy lense my aim is to develop an educational website that teaches kids critical thinking whilst engaging with in-class text and film, creating an AI artifact from students input to set up in class discussion around the reading or film.

Project Goal

The abstract goal of this project is to develop a tool/experience for students that functions in the classroom at the start of a lesson to reflect on class assigned media. From their experience and input it AI will create an artifact that reflects the students individual input, as well as classmates, in a digestible graphic to spark class discussion and show the teacher where students are with the media.
The AI ethicacy of this tool comes from its output based on the students interaction, creating a closed loop conversation in the background, and highlighting at the end how the students input effected the final product.

As part of my final output my goal is to create a 10-15 minute experience for late-primary to intermediate aged children, roughly 9-13. This will be via published website for anyone to access.

Precedents: Spark Notes

Spark Notes is a study guide website, supplying guides for popular books, plays, and films to intermediate/high school age students.

The websites guides turn large texts into easily digestible sections for review after students finish reading or consuming media. It's simple guides help not only students, but teachers alike with ways to discuss key themes and ideas in media, it functions not as a replacement for consuming media but as a guide for students afterwards.

What I like about spark notes is how digestible it makes difficult texts and media, what I dislike is its simplicity, which make sense for it's audience but does make it not incredibly interactive and quite a passive activity rather than engaging it's users in the work it is consuming. Due to it's study guide nature it doesn't push students to think for themselves, instead pushing them toward existing ideas around the text they are studying.

The other key issue lies in students using Spark Notes as a replacement for reading texts, rather than a suppliment for review.



Quickfire Precedents



The Stanley Parable is a narrative game that relies on the play ignoring what the games narrator says and doing the opposite to progress the story.

It's unique ignore the authority story makes players think outside the box whilst also giving instructions on how to play the game, and functions as a walking simulator, having the player in a first person perspective actively experiencing the narration.

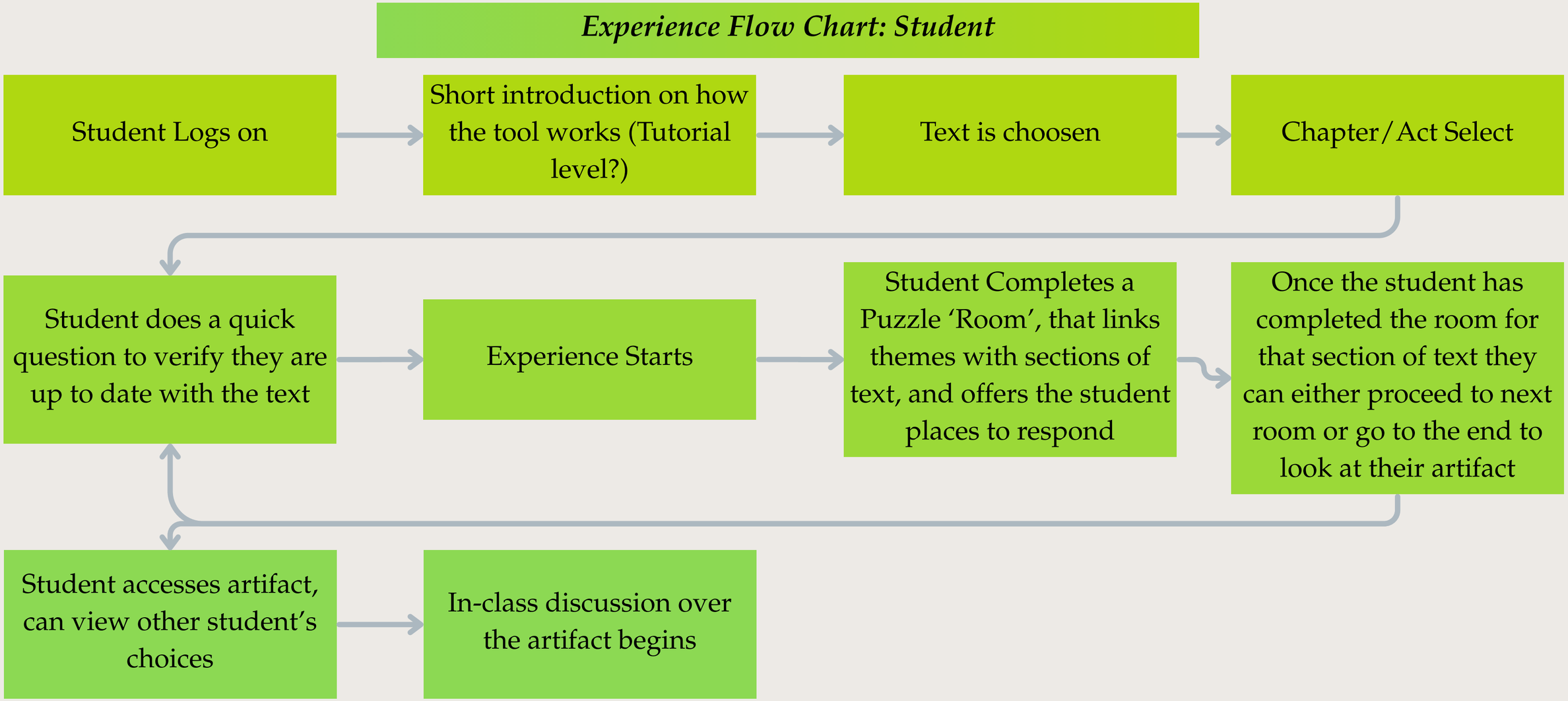


Papers Please is a game where you play as a boarder gaurd, you must apply laws and logic on who may or may not cross the boarder.

The main reason for looking to this game as a precedent is how it tell its story, through learning the mechanics and just doing your job you slowly start to learn about the politics and persons stories

Filtering in story elements to the puzzle section could be an interesting angle on helping students revise their in class text.

Intial Sketches



Intial Sketches

Experience Flow Chart: Teacher

Short introduction on the tool with the students

Unlocks text and chapter choice for students

Can assist with Students in person as they walk through the experience

Teacher presents the students artifact and is able to discuss where students are at within the text and the themes they feel strongly about to tailor in-class discussion

Teacher can access artifact, and students written responses for review later

Experience Flow Chart: AI

Puts students through introduction, (Maybe a no conquences Tutorial)

Follows students choices on themes, and pathway through the experience

Based on Student choice and pathway it puts together an artifact, and pushes the written responses through the backend to the teacher perspective.

Intial Sketches: Experience Map

Website Landing Page

Student Login Via School, Class, and Name

Student onboarding for new students

Runs through a tutorial on how the experience functions and how the student can use it

Shows an AI dsclaimer and explanation at the end for students

Student Bookshelf to show assigned readings and previous text

Student selects assigned text

One question to check student has completed the reading

Walk experience starts, student completes puzzles based on their own opinions of the text, looking at themes and connections

Student once completed puzzles for that chapter/section exits the room

Once all assigned sections are complete student is taken to AI artifact

Teacher Login Via Email

Teacher Dashboard

Review previous Student work

Shows old Artifact, and Student's written responses

Assign Reading Via Text and Chapter to whole class

Quick Review if same text but previous chapter has been asigned before

Once all students are finished Artifact is used to start classroom conversation

Intial Sketches

Prototype notes for capstone review

WELCOME

Reading, with a thinking partner

Before you begin, here's exactly what's happening on this page and what isn't.

Nothing you write is read by the AI

What you type at each stop stays exactly as you typed it. No AI reads it, changes it, scores it or summarises it. At the end you'll see your own sentences, word for word.

The AI only maps where you walked

It knows which way you turned, where you stopped, and how long you stayed. It turns *that* into the picture at the end — never your words, never what you meant.

One question, then it's yours

There's a single question at each door to check you've read the scene. It isn't marked and it isn't saved. Get it wrong as many times as you like — it just sends you back to the text.

Note for teachers and parents: there is no open chat with the AI anywhere in this experience, and no student writing is sent to a model. The door questions are recall checks on the text and are not recorded or reported. The end-of-session map is generated from navigation data only. Written responses are shown back verbatim and are designed to be read aloud in class discussion.

Choose your book

Prototype notes for capstone review

YOUR BOOKSHELF

What are you reading for class?

Pick the text your teacher has set today.

Romeo and Juliet — Act I
Ready — your tapestry starts here

The Lighthouse Keeper's Coat
The Lighthouse Keeper's Coat
Coming soon

The Tree That Never Stopped Giving
The Tree That Never Stopped Giving
Coming soon

Back

Open this book

Intial Sketches

ACT I, SCENE 1 — A PUBLIC PLACE, VERONA

The brawl in the square

Servants of both houses have drawn swords in the street. By the time the Prince arrives, the fight has pulled in half the town.

The door is shut.

One question, just to show you've read the scene. It isn't marked and it isn't saved — the text is below, and you can look at it as long as you like.

Which house do Sampson and Gregory serve?

- The house of Capulet
- The house of Montague
- Neither — they serve the Prince
- The house of Escalus

THE SCENE

Enter SAMPSON and GREGORY, of the house of Capulet, with swords and bucklers.

SAMPSON

Do you bite your thumb at us, sir?

ABRAM

I do bite my thumb, sir.

Enter BENVOLIO.

BENVOLIO

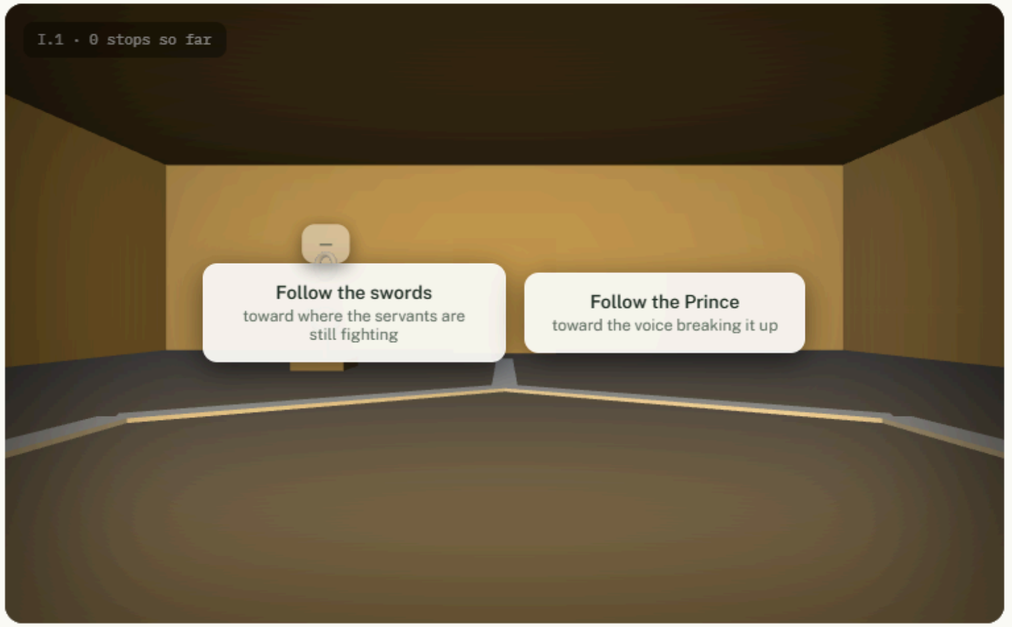
Back

Still walking...

ACT I, SCENE 1 — A PUBLIC PLACE, VERONA

The brawl in the square

Servants of both houses have drawn swords in the street. By the time the Prince arrives, the fight has pulled in half the town.



THE SCENE, IN FULL — IT STAYS OPEN THE WHOLE WAY

Enter SAMPSON and GREGORY, of the house of Capulet, with swords and bucklers.

SAMPSON

Do you bite your thumb at us, sir?

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I do bite my thumb, sir.

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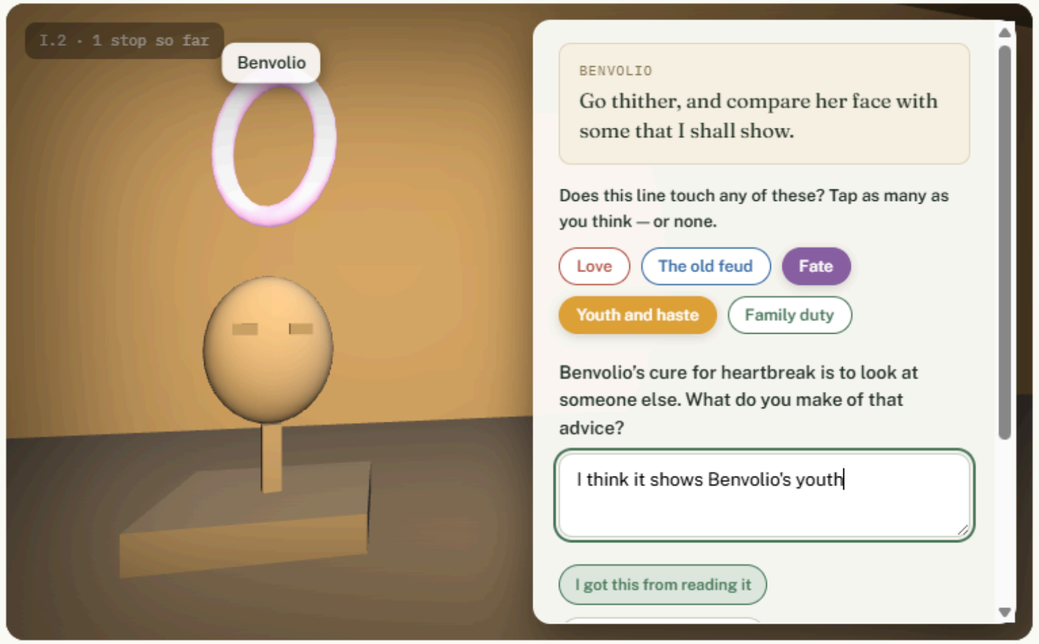
Intial Sketches

I.1 I.2 I.3 I.4 I.5

ACT I, SCENE 2 — A STREET OUTSIDE CAPULET'S HOUSE

The list nobody can read

Capulet is throwing a feast. He sends a servant out with the guest list, without noticing the servant can't read.



THE SCENE, IN FULL — IT STAYS OPEN THE WHOLE WAY

SERVANT

I am sent to find those persons whose names are here writ, and can never find what names the writing person hath here writ. I must to the learned.

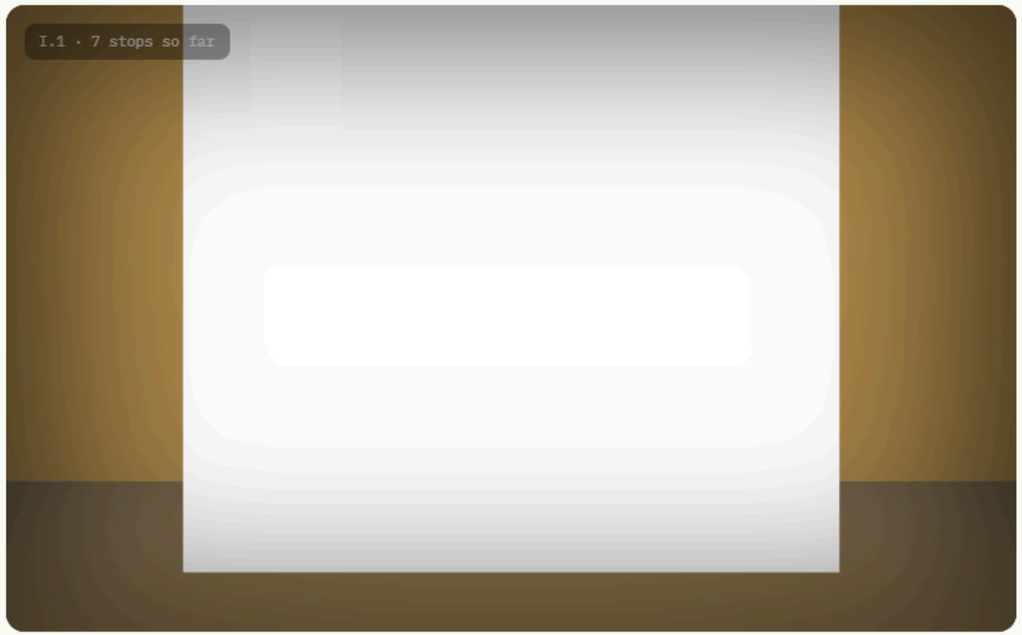
He hands the paper to ROMEO, who reads it aloud.

ROMEO

Signior Martino and his wife and daughters; County Anselme and his beauteous sisters; the lady

The brawl in the square

Servants of both houses have drawn swords in the street. By the time the Prince arrives, the fight has pulled in half the town.



THE SCENE, IN FULL — IT STAYS OPEN THE WHOLE WAY

Enter SAMPSON and GREGORY, of the house of Capulet, with swords and bucklers.

SAMPSON

Do you bite your thumb at us, sir?

ABRAM

I do bite my thumb, sir.

Enter BENVOLIO.

BENVOLIO

Back

Through the door →

Intial Sketches

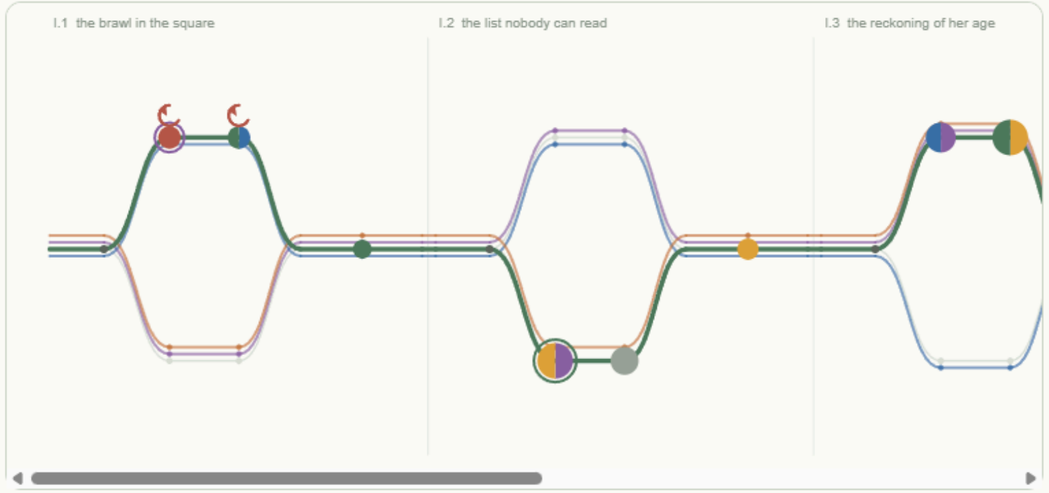
YOUR ARTIFACT

The way you went

All of Act I, left to right. Your route is drawn in; the paths nobody took are ghosted. Your classmates are on the same line — watch where you cross.

Scroll sideways to follow the act →

Hide my class



your route · themes you tapped · ringed = from reading · ringed = from class · ringed = from elsewhere

path not taken · where you turned back

sample classmates: Rio · Sam · Nara

16	14	2	1	2	0
stops made	lines you tagged	you wrote about	from reading	from class talk	from elsewhere

5	3.5
times you went back	minutes stopped

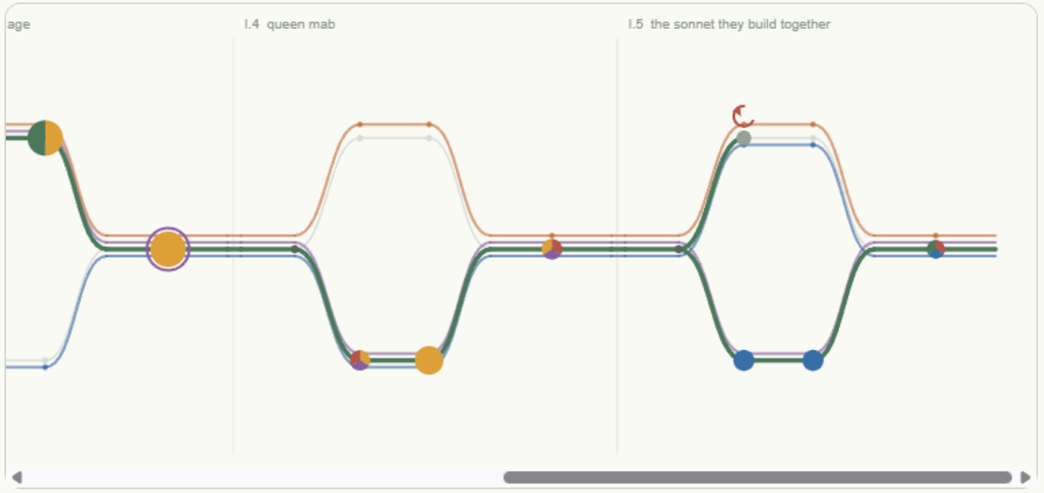
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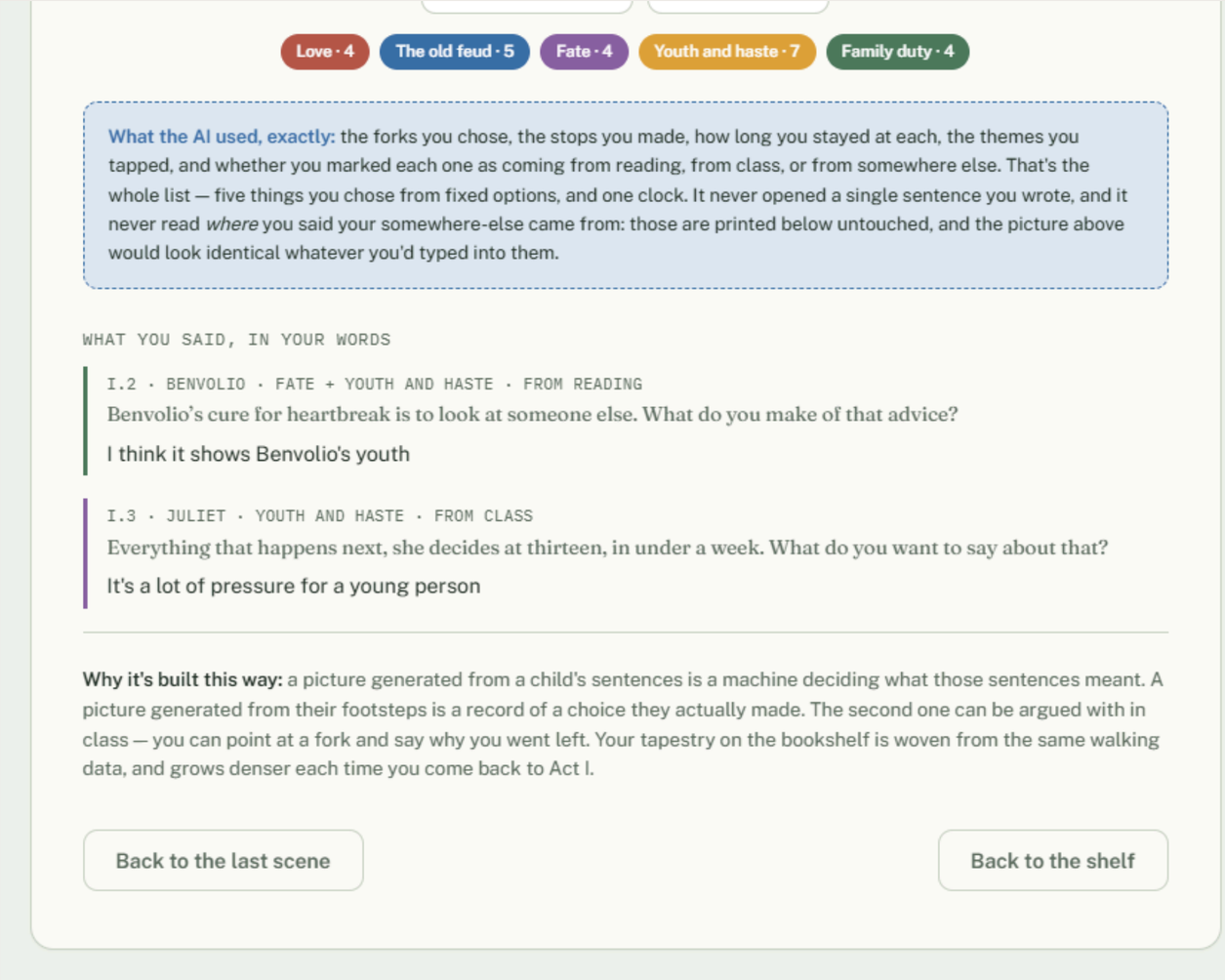
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Intial Sketches



Next Steps

- Build out of puzzle feature
  - More winding feeling and connects across the initial fork
- Introduction room
  - Short room with a online text to get students to understand the tool and how it works
- Unique versions of the final Artifact
  - Something that could be put onto the classroom wall and quickly reflects the text at a glance.

Optional

- *Teacher Dashboard*
  - *Building out the teacher dashboard section of the site.*
- *Easter Egg?*

Timeline

7

31st-6th Sep

- Build out Prototype further,
- Revisit room layout designs,

8

7th-13th Sep

- Introduction/Tutorial Room Build out,
- Homepage build out,

9

14th-20th Sep

- Artifact generation refinement
- Minor user testing with friends for feedback,

10

21st-27th Sep

- Teacher review for feedback on educational value,
- About section is complete,

11

28th-4th Oct

- Revist all prior sections and polish,
- *Teacher Dashboard goes here if time allows*

12

5th-11th Oct

- Full Publishing
- Report and documentation touch-ups
- Final Polishing

Living Document Detailing process and journaling updates.

Milestones

1. Tutorial Room
   a. Functioning 2-5 Minute tutorial room that explains how the software works.
2. Artifact
   a. Well presented artifact, with details around AI creation, and an image that would stand alone well on a classroom wall.
3. Completed 5 Puzzle rooms
   a. 5 Puzzlerooms completed with one well presented artifact at the end.

Publishing

My final output will be a public website where the HTML and other script is hosted, with a student end and teacher end.

Alongside the public website with the tool, I will push out am information and home page which shows the intention and tools clearly to parents and teachers and shows them a guide on seting up a classroom and how the tool might be used. This will include a contact feature to allow for feedback, and recommendations from users.

Evaluation

Key outcomes for the project will be

- *Tutorial*
  - *A short single puzzle room with prompts to teach the students how to use the experience*
- *Homepage*
  - *A homepage with an about section to show Parents, Teachers, and students how the website works and what the goals of the experience are.*
- *5 Working Puzzle Rooms*
  - *Workable puzzle rooms that allow for the students to review and reflect their in class text.*
- *Presentable Artifact on Completion of Puzzle Rooms*
  - *Interesting artifact that reflects the students input and shows how AI and their input collaborate to create the artifact.*
- *Published Website containing all of the above*

The success of the project will be a functioning 5-15 Minute experience including the tutorial and 5 puzzle rooms, as well as sometime spent for the reviewing of the final artifact.

Evaluation

Criteria	*Exellent*	*Good*	*Satisfactory*	*Limited*	*Poor*
Technical	Experience runs fully on publlished website, puzzle rooms, artifact generation, and persistant across sessions	Core experience functions and is published, some minor bugs or part of input is unreliable.	Core experience is completed with known breaks or bugs, only partially deployed	Work is functioning in isolation or sections, but experience doesn't run entirely. Is partially deployed.	Prototype doesn't run reliably
AI Literacy and Ethical Framing	The reavel shows a clear boundary between the students input and what the AI read from it, the student can clearly state their impact and what the AI did when asked	Boundary of the AI input and student work is clearly shown at the reveal, and followable by the student	AI's role is explained but isn't demonstrated well through the interaction	Explanation is generic, the tool doesn't show the how the students work has impacted the final artifact	No Meaningful treatment of the AI's role in the software,
Professionality / Usability	Well put together, ready to use in a classroom setting, design is legible for target group, and visual style is consistent accross tool	Coherent and usable throughout the website, a few minor improvements could be made to accessibility,	Funtionally works, visual inconsistancies and lacks polish	Usable only with direction,	Confusing or unusable without me present
Documentation Process	Documentation is clear, and includes frequent entries detailing actions taken	Documentation is clear, and shows regular entries with some detail	Documentation is present, and shows some entries with detail	Documentation is shomewhat present, had few entries, and not much detail	Documentation isn't present, or is very limited

Reference and AI Use

The Spinoff. (2026, July 23). AI cheating in NZQA exams. The Spinoff. https://thespinoff.co.nz/vertical-videos/now-you-know/ai-cheating-in-nzqa-exams
(The Spinoff, 2026)

Claude was used for the sketeches and for assistance with the Evaluation rubric, All writing and ideas are my own.